

FINS5557 Applied AI in Finance — Marking Criteria

Track A: Tech Team

Total marks: 100 (weighted at 30% of final grade) **Due:** Week 8, Friday 11:59 PM **Project:** Part A — Tech Team

1. Technical Implementation — 60 marks

1a. Core AI/ML Integration — 25 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	22–25	Sophisticated AI/ML integration with well-justified model selection; model is demonstrably fit-for-purpose; edge cases handled; inference pipeline is robust and efficient
Distinction	18–21	Functional integration with appropriate model choice; application performs reliably across typical inputs; minor gaps in robustness
Credit	15–17	Working AI/ML integration with some limitations; model choice is adequate but not well-justified; occasional failures on non-standard inputs
Pass	10–14	Basic integration present but with recurring issues; model may be mismatched to the problem or poorly configured
Fail	0–9	AI/ML component is absent, non-functional, or trivially applied (e.g., a single API call with no meaningful integration)

Assessed on: model selection rationale, inference quality, error handling, fit to use case.

1b. Code Quality and Engineering — 20 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	18–20	Professional-grade code; clear modular structure; meaningful Git commit history; security best practices (no hardcoded keys, input sanitisation); at least one documented performance optimisation
Distinction	15–17	Clean, readable code with good structure; Git used consistently; security considerations addressed; minor issues with modularity or documentation
Credit	12–14	Functional code with inconsistent quality; Git history present but sparse; basic security observed; limited evidence of architectural thought
Pass	8–11	Code runs but is poorly structured; minimal version control; security gaps present; no evidence of optimisation
Fail	0–7	Code does not run, is heavily plagiarised, or lacks any engineering discipline

Assessed on: structure, readability, Git discipline, security, `requirements.txt`, `README.md` completeness.

1c. User Interface and Experience — 15 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	13–15	Intuitive, polished interface; clear user instructions; responsive design where applicable; visual feedback for all AI processing states (loading, success, error)
Distinction	11–12	Functional and user-friendly; most states communicated clearly; minor UX gaps
Credit	9–10	Basic usability; interface works but requires user effort to understand; limited feedback states
Pass	6–8	Interface functional but confusing or visually broken in places

Band	Marks	Descriptor
Fail	0–5	Interface absent, non-functional, or unusable

2. Written Report — 25 marks

2a. Introduction — 3 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	3	Problem statement is precise and well-motivated; target users are clearly defined; objectives are specific and measurable
Distinction	2.5	Clear problem statement and user definition; objectives present but could be more specific
Credit	2	Problem described but motivation is thin; objectives are generic
Pass	1–1.5	Problem statement is vague; objectives missing or trivial
Fail	0	Section absent or does not address requirements

2b. Background and Literature Review — 4 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	4	5–7 sources critically engaged (not merely listed); relevant AI/ML techniques contextualised in the finance domain; existing applications analysed; approach justified against alternatives
Distinction	3–3.5	Adequate sources with meaningful engagement; techniques explained; approach justified
Credit	2–2.5	Sources present but superficially described; limited critical engagement

Band	Marks	Descriptor
Pass	1–1.5	Fewer than five sources; literature review is descriptive rather than analytical
Fail	0	Fewer than three sources or section absent

2c. Methodology — 6 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	5.5–6	Architecture diagram present and accurate; model selection justified with quantitative or qualitative evidence; dataset described with provenance, size, and preprocessing; development challenges and solutions documented
Distinction	4.5–5	Architecture described clearly; model justification adequate; dataset described; challenges noted
Credit	3.5–4	Architecture described in prose without diagram; model selection stated but not justified; dataset partially described
Pass	2–3	Methodology thin; architecture absent; model choice unexplained
Fail	0–1	Section absent or does not describe how the system was built

2d. Results and Evaluation — 6 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	5.5–6	Quantitative performance metrics reported; AI model effectiveness measured against a baseline; user testing conducted with at least three users and a structured instrument; limitations candidly assessed

Band	Marks	Descriptor
Distinction	4.5–5	Performance metrics present; user testing conducted; limitations noted
Credit	3.5–4	Some metrics reported; user testing minimal or informal; limitations acknowledged
Pass	2–3	Results described qualitatively only; user testing absent or undocumented
Fail	0–1	No evaluation presented

2e. Ethical Considerations — 3 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	3	Biases identified and linked to data or model design; privacy and regulatory obligations addressed (Privacy Act, APRA CPS 234 as applicable); responsible AI principles applied with specific design decisions cited; societal impact substantively assessed
Distinction	2.5	Most ethical dimensions addressed with reasonable depth
Credit	2	Ethics section present but generic; no specific design decisions linked to ethical principles
Pass	1–1.5	Superficial treatment; biases or privacy not addressed
Fail	0	Section absent or boilerplate only

2f. References — 3 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	3	Seven or more credible sources; consistent APA 7th or IEEE format throughout; all in-text citations matched to reference list
Distinction	2.5	Seven or more sources; minor formatting inconsistencies
Credit	2	Five to six sources; some formatting errors

Band	Marks	Descriptor
Pass	1–1.5	Fewer than five sources or significant citation errors
Fail	0	Fewer than three sources, no reference list, or plagiarised citations

3. Video Demonstration — 15 marks

Band	Marks	Descriptor
High Distinction	13–15	All three members speak substantively; live demonstration is clear and smooth; AI integration explained accurately; at least one limitation acknowledged honestly; audio and video quality are professional
Distinction	11–12	All members present; demonstration functional; AI integration explained; minor quality or content gaps
Credit	9–10	Most members present; demonstration works; explanation is adequate but shallow
Pass	6–8	One or more members absent; demonstration has gaps; explanation is unclear
Fail	0–5	Video absent, shorter than three minutes, or demonstration does not work

Grade Boundaries

Grade	Mark range	Description
High Distinction (HD)	85–100	Outstanding work demonstrating mastery of AI application in finance, sophisticated analysis, and professional-quality communication

Grade	Mark range	Description
Distinction (D)	75–84	Strong work with minor gaps; demonstrates solid command of the domain and clear communication
Credit (CR)	65–74	Competent work meeting most requirements; some gaps in depth, rigour, or presentation quality
Pass (P)	50–64	Meets minimum requirements; significant gaps in one or more areas
Fail (F)	0–49	Does not meet minimum requirements in one or more major components

Innovation Bonus (up to 5 marks, added after scaling)

Up to **5 bonus marks** may be awarded at examiner discretion for novel problem framing, a genuinely new application concept, or a technically ambitious implementation that goes beyond course examples. Bonus marks cannot raise a submission above 100.

Penalties

Condition	Penalty
Contribution statement absent	–5 marks
Member not appearing or speaking in video	–5 marks per absent member
AI tool use not disclosed	–10 marks
Evidence of plagiarism or academic misconduct	Zero for the entire submission; referral to UNSW Academic Conduct Board
Late submission	–5% per calendar day (maximum 5 days; zero thereafter unless extension approved)